ELVIS SAFARY, PhD

Epidemiologist | Implementation Science Scientist

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Strategic global health leader and PhD epidemiologist with 13+ years of experience across Sub-Saharan Africa, Europe, and Latin America. Expertise in women's health, SRHR, implementation research, point-of-care diagnostics, and health systems strengthening. Proven ability to lead multicountry programmes, secure funding, and translate evidence into policy and practice.

EXPERIENCE

FIND (Foundation for Innovative New Diagnostics) *Geneva, Switzerland (Hybrid)*

Head of Women's Health Programme • January 2025 – Present

- **Program Leadership:** Oversee multiple projects and clinical/implementation studies across FIND's Women's Health portfolio, with direct accountability for scientific quality, delivery timelines, and stakeholder alignment.
- **Scientist:** Directed a $1.5M multi-country portfolio (KfW/BMZ-funded) spanning 5 countries; led HPV DNA testing scale-up reaching 5,004 women across 40 commune health stations in Vietnam and contributed to securing $2M in cervical cancer programme funding.

Senior Scientist & Project Lead, Women's Health and NCD Programme • August 2021 – December 2024

- **Cervical Cancer & HPV:** Led work-package strategy for a cervical cancer elimination portfolio, spanning primary HPV screening pathways, product introduction, and country policy alignment
- **Maternal Diagnostics:** Directed diagnostic evidence generation for anemia and pre-eclampsia point-of-care tools, integrating clinical and operational research to inform product positioning in LMIC health systems.
- **Study Protocol & Regulatory Leadership:** Developed clinical study protocols and CRFs and led submissions to Ethics Committees/IRBs and local regulatory bodies in full compliance with ICH-GCP requirements.
- **Market Assessment & Shaping:** Supported design and implementation of in-country market assessments and market-shaping plans for diagnostic and health product introduction across LMICs.
- **Policy Advocacy:** Executed targeted advocacy and policy engagement on product introduction and clinical guidelines, working directly with Ministries of Health, regulatory bodies, and district health teams.
- **Health Economic Modelling & Operational Research:** Conducted implementation, operational, and health-economic modelling studies underpinning cost-effective diagnostic screening and chronic disease management delivery models.
- **Donor Engagement:** Held overall accountability for program delivery, strategic leadership, managerial oversight, and donor engagement (KfW & BMZ) across FIND's scope of work.
- **Gender & GBV Strategy:** Guided strategic programming of Gender and GBV-related projects and studies within the Women's Health portfolio.
- **Clinical Evidence Strategy:** Developed and submitted ICH-GCP compliant clinical study protocols and CRFs to IRB/EC bodies achieving 100% on time ethical approval, Oversaw clinical evidence strategies for R&D projects and held responsibility for the clinical evidence generation plan.

Heidelberg University, Institute of Global Health *Germany*

Postdoctoral Researcher • January 2024 – Present

- **Diagnostic R&D & Policy Shaping:** Focused on R&D of point-of-care devices for women's health and NCDs, including policy shaping and ecosystem strengthening
- **Technical advisor:** provide technical advisor for LMIC projects in Kenya, Tanzania and Ghana related to SRHR, gender-based violence and adolescent and young women, community system strengthening and HIV

Field Coordinator & Data Manager • October 2018 – August 2021

- **Breast & Cervical Cancer Implementation Research:** Led implementation research on breast and cervical cancer screening pathways in Tanzania, including patient delay and treatment-seeking behavior, directly informing screen-and-treat and referral models relevant to iBreastExam-type interventions.
- **Digital Health & Data Science:** Engineered automated Python (Pandas) pipelines to wrangle longitudinal, multi-country datasets, ensuring high data integrity for health systems and policy-strengthening research.
- **Decision-Support Dashboards:** Developed professional-grade dashboards using Quarto, Plotly, and iTables, transforming complex NCD and HIV/AIDS data into searchable, interactive tools for international stakeholders.
- **Strategic Research & Policy Leadership:** Served as Co-PI for HIV/GBV studies in Tanzania, leading technical research design and Python-based policy analysis to generate scalable community health models.
- **Data Governance & Stakeholder Engagement:** Managed the end-to-end data lifecycle and ICT infrastructure while leveraging data-driven insights to secure donor engagement and convert research outcomes into concrete financial targets.

Mukikute TB/HIV Organization — *Tanzania*

Senior Data Manager & Health System Strengthening Advisor • November 2014 – June 2018

- **Program Support:** Supported the planning, implementation, and evaluation of TB/HIV screening, care, and treatment programs at community level across a multi-sector consortium (SRMNH & GBV; Nutrition and Livelihood; Water & Sanitation; Health Communication; TB/HIV; HIV/AIDS; NCD; Infectious Diseases).
- **Data Systems Leadership:** Set up data management systems for the data center, together with implementation, review, and monitoring of systems.
- **Database Design & Validation:** Designed, set up, and validated databases and data-entry screens for research projects.
- **Community Implementation:** Worked directly with community-based organizations and communities in designing and monitoring project outcomes across HIV, SRH, TB, and GBV projects.
- **Qualitative & Quantitative Analysis:** Performed analysis to develop solutions driving behavioral change at the community level.

Health Education & Livelihood Empowerment (HELE) — *Tanzania*

Program Director – Reproductive Health, Maternal, Child & Adolescent Program • April 2012 – November 2014

- **Programmatic Oversight:** Held supervisory and programmatic oversight for the Reproductive, Maternal and Child Health program, including access to family planning for health spacing and planned pregnancies.
- **Health Systems Strengthening:** Improved access to quality health services and strengthened ownership and management of health services by communities, in partnership with local government and service providers.
- **Key & Vulnerable Population Programming:** Successfully implemented a key and vulnerable population project spanning biomedical services (HIV, NCDs, GBV & Family Planning) and social and behavior change communication (SBCC).
- **Guideline Co-Creation:** Designed and implemented maternal and newborn health programs, integrating co-creation methodologies to tailor clinical guidelines.
- **Data Quality Management:** Managed data queries and resolution in a timely and accurate manner across program monitoring systems.
- **Gender Evidence Generation:** Generated programmatic evidence needed for mainstreaming gender and addressing gender inequalities that hinder access to and use of HIV prevention, care, and treatment services.

EDUCATION & CREDENTIALS

- PhD, Public Health, Policy & Epidemiology — Heidelberg University, Institute of Global Health, Germany (2022)
- Certificate, Management & Research of Health Care Systems — Technische Universität, Germany (2017)
- MSc, Public Health & Epidemiology — Muhimbili University of Health & Allied Sciences, Tanzania (2015)
- BSc, Nursing & Midwifery — University of Nairobi, Kenya (2010)
- Diploma, Management of Information Systems — The City and Guilds of London Institute, UK (2005)

- Registered Nurse/Midwife; Certificate in Practical Project Planning and Management; short courses in medical emergency response, SRH, HIV/AIDS, human rights, and gender

SELECTED PUBLICATIONS

- Implementation research: a protocol for two three-arm pragmatic randomized controlled trials on continuous glucose monitoring devices in people with type 1 diabetes in South Africa and Kenya - PubMed (nih.gov)
- Benefits of Usability Evaluation in the Development Process of Diabetes Technologies Using the Example of a Continuous Glucose Monitoring System Prototype
- Co-creation process of an intervention to implement a multiparameter point-of-care testing device in a primary healthcare setting for non-communicable diseases in Peru
- User requirements for non-invasive and minimally invasive glucose self-monitoring devices in low-income and middle-income countries: a qualitative study in Kyrgyzstan, Mali, Peru and Tanzania
- Facilitators and barriers of the implementation of point-of-care devices for cardiometabolic diseases: a scoping review
- Performance Assessment of three continuous glucose monitoring systems in Adults with Type-1 Diabetes 2023.
- Knowledge, implementation and gaps of the gender-based violence management guideline among health care workers 2023.
- Family role and causes of delay in seeking treatment by cervical cancer patients after diagnosis in Dar es Salaam, Tanzania. 2017.
- An overview on Acute malnutrition and Food Insecurity among Children during the conflict in Yemen 2019.
- Reorienting Primary Health Care Services for Non-communicable diseases: a comparative preparedness assessment of two healthcare networks in Malawi and Zambia 2021.
- Role of community health volunteers in identifying people with elevated blood pressure for diagnosis and monitoring of hypertension in Malawi 2021.
- Knowledge, experience and perception of gender-based violence health services: a mixed method study on adolescent girls and young women in Tanzania 2021.

Core skills

- Global health strategy and Programme development
- Women's health, SRHR and Gender-responsive programming
- Implementation and Epidemiological research (mixed methods)

REFERENCES – *available upon request*